

A BLAST FROM THE PAST
Tom Watson, left, shares the lead at Pebble Beach with Tim Herron. D6



AUSTRALIAN OPEN
Korda wins 1st Grand Slam title. D9

PREP WRESTLING
Fairview rallies, beats Ridgeville. D9

COLLEGE BASKETBALL
Cleveland St. drops a close one. D4

Sports

The Chronicle / SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 1, 1998 D1



DAN COUGHLIN

The mystique of Super Joe keeps growing

The day before the Indians' home opener in 1980, Joe Charboneau, an obscure rookie left fielder, snuggled up to the bar of the Stadium Club and ordered a beer. "A bottle, not a can," he said, "and don't open it."

The beer arrived promptly, whereupon Charboneau jammed the top of the bottle into his right eye socket and began twisting, as though he were screwing the beer bottle through his eyeball. After a few twists, he squinted and the bottle cap popped out and landed on the bar.

The man sitting at the next stool gasped.

Charboneau then leaned his head back and inserted the beer bottle in his right nostril. He began pouring the beer through his nose and down his nasal passages, from where it eventually found its way into his stomach.

Records are sketchy and the Society for American Baseball Research is of little help, but it is believed that Charboneau was the first player in American League history who could perform that trick.

In the course of the afternoon, Charboneau related his story of growing up poor in California, occasionally earning \$10 or \$20 by fighting semiorganized bouts in boxcars.

There was never enough money for medical treatment, so he extracted his own teeth with a Vice-Grip.

When he was stabbed in the arm in a knife fight, he sutured the wound himself with his mother's needle and fishing line.

He showed the scar on his finger where the alligator almost bit it off, the last time Joe ever played with a baby alligator.

The scar on his arm? Oh, that's where he removed the tattoo with a hunting knife when someone told him baseball scouts frowned on players with tattoos.

A gregarious fellow who made time for everyone, Charboneau was sought out by reporters in every city the Indians visited.

At the same time, he was having one hellacious season on the field and was voted the American League Rookie of the Year.

Baseball writer Terry Pluto nicknamed him "Super Joe." A song written about him received heavy play on the radio all summer.

Two years later he was back in the minors after undergoing surgery for a ruptured disc. The doctors insisted on using an anesthetic, although Joe said it was not necessary.

Joe lives in Avon Lake now and runs a baseball school for youngsters. He is content to let his bizarre past gather dust, claiming the stories were over-dramatized.

Old habits, however, are not easily broken.

At the Indians Fantasy Camp

See COUGHLIN, D9

A win and a loss

Cavs beat Pistons; Anderson out 6-8 weeks

Rick Noland
The Chronicle-Telegram

CLEVELAND — Saturday was a good news, bad news kind of night for the Cavs.

On the same evening they beat the Detroit Pistons 90-88 behind a career-high 32 points from center Zydrunas Ilgauskas, the Cavs also learned they will be without guard Derek Anderson for six to eight weeks.

Anderson, however, insists he'll be back sooner.

"Six to eight weeks is for someone 50 years old who sits around the house and doesn't do anything," the 23-year-old said. "Athletes are different. I'll be back in three or four (weeks)."

Anderson, injured early in the second quarter Friday in Indiana, was originally expected to

NEXT UP

WHO: Cavs vs. Timberwolves
WHEN: Monday, 7:30 p.m.
WHERE: Gund Arena
TV/RADIO: Fox Sports Ohio; WTAM AM-1100

miss two to four weeks, but a follow-up examination Saturday at the Cleveland Clinic revealed he has a partial tear of the medial collateral ligament in his right knee.

It was at this time last year, on Jan. 18 to be exact, that Anderson tore the anterior cruciate ligament in the same knee during his senior season at Kentucky. Earlier in his career, the 6-foot-5 guard suffered the same injury to

his left knee while at Ohio State.

"The good news is his ACL is intact," Cleveland coach Mike Fratello said. "That wasn't damaged."

No surgery is planned, but Anderson will be examined again on Monday.

"I was blessed it didn't hurt me that bad," he said. "It was just a mild sprain. I was very fortunate."

The injury occurred when teammate Danny Ferry drew a charging foul on Indiana's Antonio Davis, only to fall backward onto Anderson's knee.

"His whole body fell on me," Anderson said. "I couldn't break the fall because I didn't see him."

Prior to the injury, Anderson was enjoying a stellar rookie sea-

See CAVS, D9



AP

TOUGH DEFENSE: Cleveland's Cedric Henderson, left, and Shawn Kemp block the path of Detroit's Grant Hill during the Cavs' 90-88 win Saturday night at Gund Arena. The Cavs found out before the game that guard Derek Anderson is expected to miss 6 to 8 weeks with a knee injury.

River ends Falls' streak

Pirates hand Bulldogs 1st SWC loss in 40 games

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

OLMSTED FALLS — Jim Rucki wasn't even tempted to say that he was going to Disney World.

In fact the Rocky River basketball coach said he hadn't given Olmsted Falls' 39-game Southwestern Conference winning streak a thought before the two teams squared off in a league showdown.

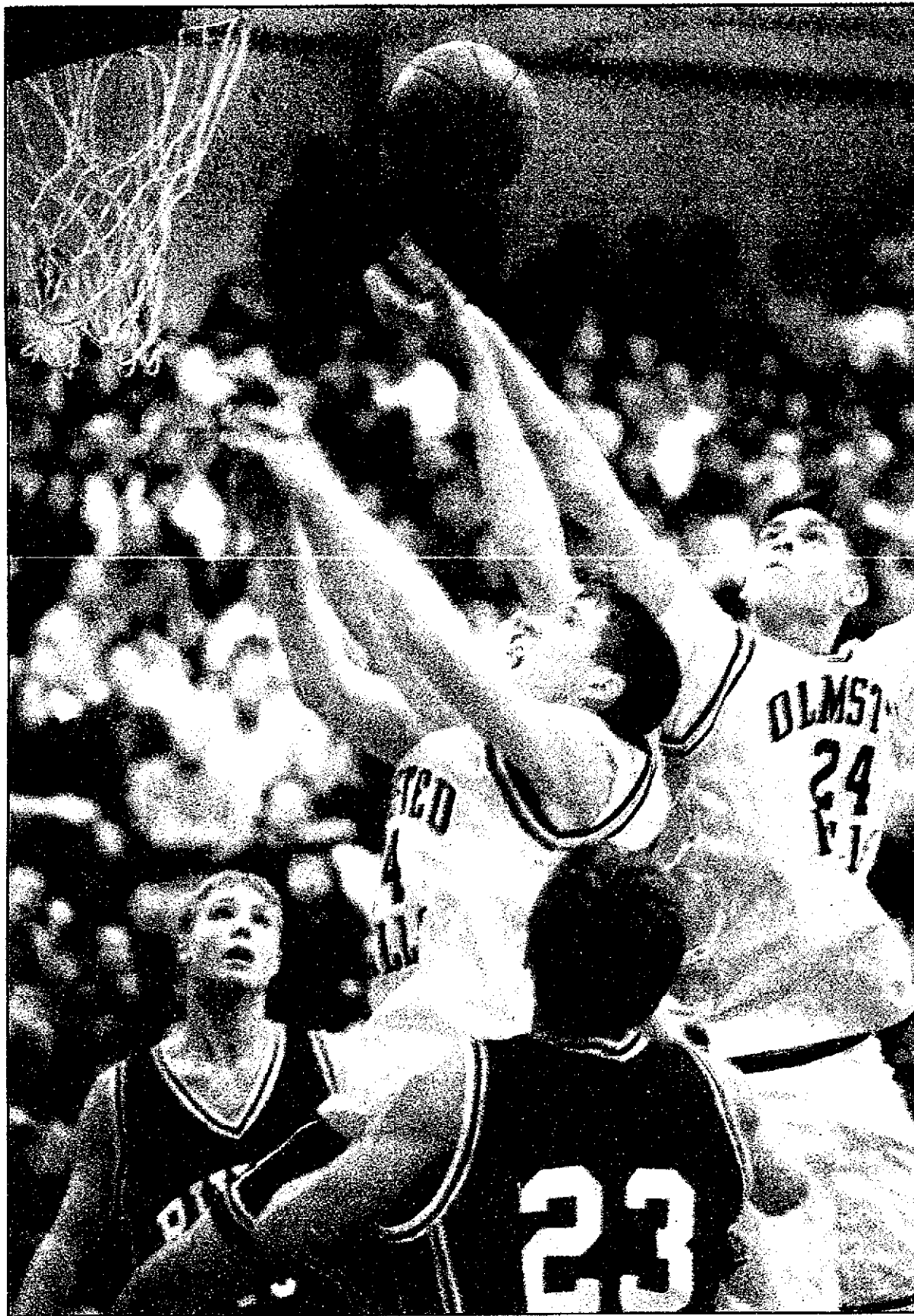
But if any coach deserved a moment in the limelight, it was Rucki after his Pirates' 56-44 win over the Bulldogs Saturday night in front of nearly 2,000 fans, the largest crowd in at least nine years at Olmsted Falls.

The two teams now share the conference lead at 9-1, two games ahead of North Olmsted, which lost to Westlake Saturday.

"We've gone head-to-head so many times that it probably was appropriate that it was us," Rucki said. "The last four or five years we've played them three times a year."

Olmsted Falls, 11-2, had beaten Rocky River 10 straight times over the past four years — three of them in the district tournament, twice in the finals. The Bulldogs hadn't lost a conference game since Feb. 17,

See RIVER, D7



TOM MAHL / CHRONICLE

UPS Y DAISY: Olmsted Falls' Jeremy Holland (44) and Mike Gansey (24) reach for a rebound over Bob Clutterbuck (23) of Rocky River during action at Olmsted Falls Saturday night.

GIRLS BASKETBALL

Elyria runs out of gas

Mentor shuts out Pioneers over last 5 minutes

Paul Heyse
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — There was simply no juice left in the tank at the end for Elyria, as the Pioneers went scoreless for nearly the last five minutes and dropped a 58-48 verdict to Mentor on Saturday night.

The setback was Elyria's fourth in the last five games, dropping the Pioneers to 8-8 overall, 7-6 in the Lake Erie League.

On the road for seven of its last eight games, Mentor (13-3, 10-3 LEL) won its fourth straight contest and triumphed for the 12th time in the last 13 games.

The Cardinals closed the game with a 10-0 scoring run, while the Pioneers went scoreless over the final four minutes and 55 seconds of the contest.

"We ran out of gas," said Elyria girls coach Mike Walsh. "They went to the line and they beat us. We were tired."

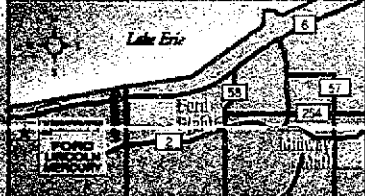
Sophomore center Sandy Lewis led Mentor's charge with a season-high 23 points while grabbing 11 rebounds. Junior forward Emily Spehek had 12 points for the Cardinals, while senior guard Jill Sluga added 11, including five of Mentor's final 10 points.

In Mentor's 57-45 win over Elyria on Dec. 13, Lewis had just six.

Mentor converted 9-of-19 second-half shots (47 percent), while Elyria was just 10 of 29 (34 percent).

"Any shot we did get off, they blocked it," said Walsh. "Every

See ELYRIA, D8



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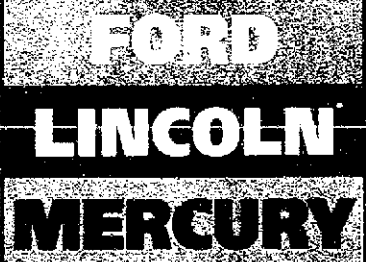
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